



POLESTAR MIDDLE EAST WEEKLY - 2026-09-19

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 13 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 19 SEPTEMBER 2026

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REGIONAL OUTLOOK

Middle East operating conditions changed across security & conflict, regulatory & policy, energy and market policy, business & operational disruption during the reporting period. Confirmed effects are concentrated in Oman, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iran through personnel and travel, sites and assets, transport and supply chains, energy and utilities, business continuity, rather than across the whole region. Security pressure matters where it changes access or movement; operational disruption matters where recovery, rerouting or alternative capacity is uncertain; and policy matters where implementation changes cost, compliance or market entry. The practical business effect should be judged from named routes, sites, services and permissions, not headline volume. Operators should maintain a country-specific view, distinguish confirmed effects from commentary, and test whether controls or recovery measures are working. Over the next week, official access restrictions, transport status, implementation guidance, hazard notices and evidence of spread or containment will determine whether exposure rises or recedes. A broader downgrade would require sustained effects across major corridors, sites or workforces. Clarified rules, verified reopening, restored services or effective containment would support stability. Update this judgement when an announcement becomes an observable operating consequence. The assessment remains concentrated on Oman, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iran and should change only when those operating conditions become observable. The regional conclusion therefore rests on transmission into services, routes and assets rather than the volume of reporting. In Oman, the immediate question is whether the disruption alters shipment availability, access controls or recovery timing; in Saudi Arabia, the test is whether vessel status, crew safety and route access recover.

REGIONAL RISK MAP



WEEK AT A GLANCE

MATERIAL DEVELOPMENTS 4	MARKETS REQUIRING WATCH 4
HIGH OR EXTREME DEVELOPMENTS 2	7-DAY WATCH ITEMS 0

REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

The regional risk picture is defined by confirmed changes across Business & Operational Disruption, Energy and Market Policy, Regulatory & Policy, Security & Conflict in Oman, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iran. These signals do not indicate a uniform deterioration; they identify specific operating questions whose consequences depend on location, duration and official response. Security and access conditions matter where they constrain personnel movement, site entry, border passage or the use of transport corridors. Operational and infrastructure pressure matters where closures, damage, outages or maritime disruption reduce available capacity and force rerouting. Supply-chain exposure is concentrated in personnel and travel, sites and assets, transport and supply chains, energy and utilities, business continuity, with the principal test being whether alternate routes, suppliers and services can absorb the interruption. Regulatory, political and energy developments require a separate implementation check because announced measures do not automatically produce an operating effect. The assessment therefore gives greater weight to confirmed impact, recovery status and enforceable controls than to headline volume, repeated commentary or raw source language. Weather, cyber and other domains were reviewed separately and are not elevated where the evidence did not establish a material consequence. Across the reporting period, the practical risk is the interaction between access, assets, logistics, people and continuity rather than any single event. Operators should retain a country-specific view, confirm the status of named facilities and routes, and record whether disruption is spreading or being contained. The picture would worsen if effects persisted across major corridors, workforces or supply links; it would stabilise if access reopened, guidance clarified, services recovered or controls contained further spread. The operating picture is therefore concentrated in Oman, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iran rather than distributed evenly across the region. Any wider conclusion should wait for evidence that services, routes or facilities beyond the named locations are affected.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

Oman | Oman maritime access disruption

Category: Operational Disruption
Current Severity: High

Assessment: Oman maritime access disruption: Oman saw violence, military activity or access restrictions near affected routes or sites. Operators should review staff movement, route availability and site access near the reported attack, with contingency arrangements ready if restrictions or further violence affect operations. Security teams should confirm facility posture, transport alternatives and communications with personnel, while managers distinguish a local incident from evidence of wider corridor disruption or repeated attacks. Local leadership should verify reopening conditions before normal travel or site routines resume.

Polestar View: Oman maritime access disruption: The commercial risk will rise if violence spreads towards transport corridors, population centres or operating sites, or if authorities impose wider access restrictions. Track staff safety, route status and site-access controls around the affected location.

Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss. In Oman, monitor operational disruption implementation signals, route status and confirmed recovery evidence.

Saudi Arabia | Saudi pipeline attack disrupts oil shipments

Category: Energy
Current Severity: High

Assessment: Saudi pipeline attack disrupts oil shipments: Saudi Arabia saw an attack affecting the East-West pipeline and Yanbu oil shipments, creating a specific question over export flows and recovery timing. Operators should review pipeline integrity, Yanbu loading status, export-flow continuity and alternate shipment capacity. Energy and security teams should compare official restoration updates with actual cargo movement, distinguish a localized disruption from broader supply impact, and prepare procurement or routing decisions if recovery milestones slip.

Polestar View: Saudi pipeline attack disrupts oil shipments: The commercial risk is tied to whether the pipeline and Yanbu disruption reduces export capacity or is contained without wider effects on regional energy logistics. Track staff safety, route status and site-access controls around the affected location.

Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: verify pipeline integrity, Yanbu loading status, export-flow restoration and any confirmed diversion of oil shipments. In Saudi Arabia, monitor energy implementation signals, route status and confirmed recovery evidence.

3 corroborating sources

Kuwait | Kuwait Airport T4 Customs Foil Drug Smuggling Attempt, Seize 4,144

Category: Regulatory
Current Severity: Low

Assessment: Kuwait Airport T4 Customs Foil Drug Smuggling Attempt, Seize 4,144 Lyrica. Operators should review staff movement, route availability and site access near the reported attack, with contingency arrangements ready if restrictions or further violence affect operations. Security teams should confirm facility posture, transport alternatives and communications with personnel, while managers distinguish a local incident from evidence of wider corridor disruption or repeated attacks. Local leadership should verify reopening conditions before normal travel or site routines resume.

Polestar View: Kuwait Airport T4 Customs Foil Drug Smuggling Attempt, Seize 4,144: Restoration timing and diversion capacity will determine whether the aviation disruption remains local or affects regional passenger and cargo schedules. Track staff safety, route status and site-access controls around the affected location.

Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track airport status notices, flight cancellations, alternate routing and restoration timing. In Kuwait, monitor regulatory implementation signals, route status and confirmed recovery evidence.

Iran | Iran border drone threat

Category: Security
Current Severity: Low

Assessment: Iran border drone threat: Iran saw violence, military activity or access restrictions near affected routes or sites. Operators should review staff movement, route availability and site access near the reported attack, with contingency arrangements ready if restrictions or further violence affect operations. Security teams should confirm facility posture, transport alternatives and communications with personnel, while managers distinguish a local incident from evidence of wider corridor disruption or repeated attacks. Local leadership should verify reopening conditions before normal travel or site routines resume.

Polestar View: Iran border drone threat: The commercial risk will rise if violence spreads towards transport corridors, population centres or operating sites, or if authorities impose wider access restrictions. Track staff safety, route status and site-access controls around the affected location.

Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss. In Iran, monitor security implementation signals, route status and confirmed recovery evidence.

7 DAY WATCH

No qualifying watch items were identified in the reporting period.

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

For regional operators, these developments translate into a cross-domain operating read rather than a second list of events. People and travel exposure is concentrated on movement restrictions, personnel safety and access decisions around affected routes and sites. Operations and assets require route-status checks, site safeguards and practical alternatives where disruption or security conditions affect access. Supply-chain and logistics exposure centres on cargo, ports, transport availability and the resilience of alternate routes or suppliers. Regulatory and market-access exposure should be tracked through implementation notices, customs or compliance changes and their effect on operating permissions and costs. Business continuity depends on whether disruption persists, recovery milestones are credible and operators can maintain critical services through contingency arrangements. For Oman, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iran, the practical priority is to preserve workable alternatives while evidence develops. The assessment should change when recovery, restriction or implementation becomes observable in the operating environment. That judgement should remain tied to verified service status, official controls and credible recovery milestones. This keeps personnel, asset, logistics and compliance decisions linked to verified reporting-period evidence.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

Middle East operating risk over the next seven days will turn on whether current access, transport and security pressures persist or are contained. The forward indicators are Oman: official access notices and confirmed recovery evidence; Saudi Arabia: official access notices and confirmed recovery evidence; Kuwait: implementation guidance and compliance effects. Escalation would become more credible if restrictions spread towards commercial sites, recovery milestones slip, or confirmed disruption reaches additional routes and suppliers. Stabilisation would be supported by verified reopening, restored services, clear implementation guidance, credible security controls or evidence that affected activity is contained. Operators should check official notices and operational status rather than infer a trend from repeated reporting. The next assessment should distinguish a temporary interruption from sustained pressure on personnel, assets, supply chains or market access, and should record whether contingency arrangements remain workable. The immediate decision is whether the named indicators alter access, staffing, logistics or compliance in the affected markets.

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